

Rationale

Provide a clear explanation of:

- Your design decisions
- How the experience reflects the brand

Overall, my redesigned experience reflects Heritage Bay's brand by placing craftsmanship, transparency and storytelling at the centre of the customer journey. Rather than presenting products as items for purchase, my experience encourages users to discover the design meaning, artisan contributions and production journey behind each piece. I kept Heritage Bay's signature black and white brand colours to maintain brand consistency, sticking to a clean and modern layout across the 10 screens of my website. I also added grey and blue as accent colours to complement the brand colours as these colours are frequently used on the website and in Heritage Bay products.

For the homepage, I prioritised improving product discoverability by showcasing featured products and providing a short description for each collection instead of only displaying collection names without any information. This addresses the pain point of the original website where first-time visitors had limited visibility of Heritage Bay's products and had to navigate into multiple collections before discovering individual items.

For the product page itself, since my scenario focused on the Kotak Melati baggy jeans, I used a carousel to showcase the different product images to improve visibility and added a prominent “Begin the Journey” button above the “Add to cart” button to encourage users to explore the story behind the product before purchasing. Placing it above the primary purchase button ensures that the feature is immediately visible and is integrated seamlessly into the product page. This reinforces Heritage Bay's commitment to preserving culture by allowing customers to discover the inspiration and craft process behind the product.

For my integrated Trace Your Craft experience, I had a 4 stage journey consisting of Design meaning, Craft processes, Meet the artisans and Final product pages which I represented with a progress bar, allowing users to clearly “track” their progress throughout the experience. Each stage was designed with consistent layouts and imagery, placing focus on the product and its craftsmanship using interactions and animations.

For the Design Meaning page, I used interactive tooltips to encourage users to actively explore the significance of the Kotak Melati motif, rather than presenting the information as large blocks of text. By clicking on different parts of the jeans, users can reveal contextual information about the motif's inspiration, symbolism and design details.

Since “Craft processes” was the core feature of Trace your craft, I used interactive card hover animations to reveal information about each production stage such as the step, date recorded and time taken for each step. This encourages users to actively explore the journey instead of passively reading the content, making the experience feel more engaging and immersive.

For the Meet the Artisans page, I wanted to shift the focus from the product to the people behind it so I featured a selected artisan with a larger profile, while the remaining artisans are presented as interactive profile cards that users can click to learn more about their roles and contributions to the piece.

References (For Prototype)

1. OpenAI. (2026). ChatGPT (GPT-5.5-mini) [Large language model]. <https://chat.openai.com/>
2. Google. (2026). Gemini (AI image generation tool) [AI-generated image]. <https://gemini.google.com/>
3. https://www.instagram.com/heritage.bay?utm_source=ig_web_button_share_sheet&igsh=ZDNlZDc0MzIxNw==
4. Heritage Bay